

- * Such claims are not uncommon. For instance the physicist Albert Michelson imagined, toward the end of the nineteenth century, that what was left for us to discover in the sciences of nature was no more than fine-tuning our precisions by a few decimal places.
- * There are more limits I haven't even attempted to discuss here. I am not even bringing up the class of incomputability people call NP completeness.
- * This idea pops up here and there in history, under different names. Alfred North Whitehead called it the "fallacy of misplaced concreteness," e.g., the mistake of confusing a model with the physical entity that it means to describe.
- * These graphs also illustrate a statistical version of the narrative fallacy—you find a model that fits the past. "Linear regression" or "R-square" can ultimately fool you beyond measure, to the point where it is no longer funny. You can fit the linear part of the curve and claim a high R-square, meaning that your model fits the data very well and has high predictive powers. All that off hot air: you only fit the linear segment of the series. Always remember that "R-square" is unfit for Extremistan; it is only good for academic promotion.